SRM Group of Educational Institutions

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Chairman: SRM Group of Institutions
Chennai Ramapuram & Trichy

MO.No./All/ 60/25 dated 01.02.2025

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Publishing Research Papers at SRM Group of Institutions (Chennai Ramapuram and Trichy)

Objective:

To standardize the process for submitting research papers for publication, ensuring adherence to quality standards, appropriate institutional affiliations, and compliance with ethical research practices.

Scope:

This SOP applies to all faculty members, researchers, and students of SRM Group of Institutions (Ramapuram and Trichy) involved in research activities intending to publish papers in peer-reviewed journals, conferences, and other academic platforms.

Procedure:

1. Manuscript Preparation:
    - Researchers must prepare their manuscripts according to the formatting and submission guidelines of the target journal or conference.
    - Ensure that the manuscript adheres to ethical standards for academic writing, with proper citations and acknowledgments.
    - Preference should be given to journals indexed in SCI/SCIE databases and journals classified under Q1/Q2 ranking categories.
    - For Easwari Engineering College, SRMIST-Ramapuram, SRMIST-Trichy and TRP Engineering College, priority should be given to journals that fall under the ASJC (All Science Journal Classification) fields of Engineering and Computer Science.
2. Authorship Guidelines:
    - If a student project is converted into a research paper, the student(s) should be listed as the first author(s), reflecting their primary contribution to the research.

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- Faculty members involved in the project should be appropriately credited as co-authors or corresponding authors based on their role.
- Any violation of authorship rules, such as omitting a student's name or misrepresenting the contribution order, will be seriously accounted for and may lead to disciplinary actions.

3. Affiliation Checking:

- All authors must include their complete and standardized institutional affiliation as per the guidelines set by SRM Group of Institutions (Ramapuram & Trichy).
- Affiliation should be formatted as per the nomenclature used by SCOPUS data base. For further clarifications on the affiliations the authors can contact the respective Institutional representative of Directorate of Research.
- Ensure that the specific campus (e.g., Easwari Engineering College or SRM Institute of Science and Technology Ramapuram Campus or SRM Institute of Science and Technology Tiruchirappalli Campus or TRP Engineering College) is mentioned to maintain uniformity in publications and avoid issues related to indexing (e.g., Scopus).

4. Similarity Check Using iThenticate:

- Before submission to any journal or conference, the manuscript must undergo plagiarism detection using iThenticate or other institution-approved plagiarism detection software.
- The similarity index must not exceed 15%, excluding citations, bibliography, and common phrases.
- Critical sections like the introduction, methodology, and results should have minimal overlap with previous work.
- A plagiarism report generated by iThenticate must be retained and submitted along with the manuscript to the journal or conference.

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5. Monitoring and Verification by the Directorate of Research:

   - The Directorate of Research will monitor all manuscripts published under the institution's affiliation to ensure compliance with research integrity standards.
   - After a paper is published, a copy of the final published manuscript along with the iThenticate report must be submitted to the Directorate for verification.
   - The Directorate of Research will verify that the manuscript has undergone a similarity check using iThenticate and that the similarity index is within acceptable limits.
   - Any manuscript found to have not been subjected to a similarity check or found to have a higher-than-permitted similarity will be considered a case of research misconduct, and appropriate disciplinary action will be taken against the responsible authors.

6. Submission to Journal/Conference:

   - Authors may submit their manuscripts to the selected journal or conference after completing the iThenticate check and ensuring compliance with the journal's guidelines.
   - Authors must ensure that the journal is reputable and indexed in recognized databases (e.g., SCI/SCIE,etc.), with a preference for Q1/Q2 journals.
   - Only journal articles published in SCI/SCIE/SCOPUS indexed journals will be considered for increments and promotions. Three Scopus-indexed journal articles will be considered equivalent to one Q1/Q2 of SCI/SCIE article, and two journal articles in Q3/Q4 of SCI/SCIE will be considered equivalent to one Q1/Q2 of SCI/SCIE article.

7. Post-Submission and Publication:

   - After submission, authors should keep records of all correspondence with the journal, including acceptance, revision requests, or rejection.

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- Once published, a copy of the final published paper along with the iThenticate report must be submitted to the Directorate of Research for record-keeping and verification purposes.

8. Responsibilities:

- Authors/Researchers: Prepare manuscripts, ensure proper affiliations, conduct similarity checks via iThenticate, and ensure all papers are submitted for post-publication verification.
- Departmental Research Coordinator: Monitor research activities, verify that the iThenticate checks are performed, and ensure compliance with institutional standards.
- Directorate of Research: Post-publication verification of manuscripts, ensuring adherence to institutional research and ethical standards, and addressing any cases of research misconduct.

9. Compliance:

- Failure to adhere to these procedures, particularly violations related to plagiarism checks or authorship rules, will be considered research misconduct and will result in appropriate disciplinary action, including but not limited to academic penalties.

R. Shivakumar

CHAIRMAN
SRM Chennai Ramapuram & Trichy

To

All HoI's in Chennai Ramapuram & Trichy to circulate

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